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Dear NetSense Participant,

With the end of the spring semester rapidly approaching, we wanted to provide you with an update regarding the status of the NetSense study and transition information regarding the end of the study. While we had hoped to continue the study into a third and fourth year, the uncertainty regarding federal funding of research necessitates that we wrap up the study as originally intended. Fortunately, Sprint has generously agreed to fund the project through the end of the summer. **Hence, you can continue to use your phone through the first week of the fall semester** at which point you will need to make arrangements for alternate cellular service as the phones will no longer continue to function. **You will also be able to keep your number** if you elect to use a different carrier.

You have two options if you wish to continue to use your phone over the summer.

Plan A: Turn in phone during the first week of the fall semester or earlier.

1. Complete a final set of three surveys at the end of the current semester. As a token of appreciation for completing all the surveys, you will receive a \$5 Amazon gift card.
2. Arrange for an alternate cellular plan
 - a. Keep your number, transition the number into a personal Sprint account (10% ND student plan discount). The phone numbers have been pre-marked to allow for liability transition.
 - b. Keep your number, arrange for an alternate cellular plan through a different carrier (Verizon, AT&T, T-Mobile, etc.). There may be fees charged by the alternate carrier for number porting.
3. Advise us via the netsense@nd.edu e-mail that you have transitioned the phone number
4. Return the phone to us by August 30th, 2013 (Friday of first week of classes). Phones can be returned to either Christine Broadbent (275 Fitzpatrick, 631-1226) or Jasmine Botello (384E Nieuwland Science Hall, 631-7095).

Particularly for those individuals studying abroad, an earlier turn-in may be desirable and can be arranged before the end of the spring semester. Shipping may be arranged as well (please see contacts above).

If you do not return our phone to us you will be charged a replacement fee of \$100 for the phone. The phone will be deactivated as of August 30th, 2013 and the fee assessed shortly thereafter.

Plan B: Retain phone and purchase your own phone plan through Sprint

We have arranged with Sprint a deal whereby you get to keep your current phone. Plan B only applies if you plan to continue using your current phone. If you would like to upgrade your phone to a new phone, please see Plan A.

1. Complete a final set of three surveys at the end of the current semester. As a token of appreciation for completing all the surveys, you will receive a \$5 Amazon gift card.
2. Transition the number into a personal Sprint account (10% ND student plan discount) some time before August 30th, 2013.
3. Advise us via the netsense@nd.edu e-mail that you have transitioned the phone number

Further Phone Subsidies

While we are not able to continue the study next year with a full subsidy of your phone plan, we would like to continue to receive data on your communication activity for the remainder of your time at Notre Dame. We are therefore offering up to one hundred current NetSense participants the opportunity to continue in the study in a limited manner. If funding allows, we may also extend an invitation to friends in your social circles with your permission.

To continue participation, you will need to have an Android phone (either your current NetSense phone or newer Android phone). Unfortunately, our agent will not function on an iPhone at this time. If you will be abroad next semester, you may resume participating when you return to ND.

The offer entails:

1. You agree to run a phone agent on your primary phone.
2. You agree to run a lightweight laptop or desktop agent on your primary computer
3. You agree to continue to stay Facebook friends with our NetSense “virtual” friend.

In turn, we will provide:

4. A monthly subsidy of \$10 payable by prepaid Visa cards at the end of each semester available through spring of 2015. The subsidy will be pro-rated subject to compliance of the monitoring agents (use of device as primary phone, etc.).

No surveys or extended data collection methods will be involved. You may be asked to periodically update the agent on the phone or laptop (once per semester). Both the phone agent and laptop agent are lightweight agents that are pared down versions of our current phone and laptop agents. A new, signed consent form will be required to participate. The form will list all monitored data aspects.

To enroll in this program, please e-mail the NetSense account (netsense@nd.edu) stating your interest in participation. Please place in the subject line of your email “Phone Subsidy Program.” The subsidy option will be made available over the summer for anyone electing to exit the study before the close of the spring semester. Questions may be directed to Prof. Striegel regarding any subsidy questions.

Closing

We would like to extend our sincere thanks for your participation in the NetSense project. The data that has been collected is yielding exceptional insights into social networks and smartphone usage. Your participation has allowed us to construct a world-class dataset that is raising the stature of Notre Dame as one of the top places for research on social networks and wireless systems. We could not have done this research without you.

If you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to contact any of us below.

Go Irish!

Profs. Striegel, Hachen, Lizardo, Poellabauer

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